

Jia Liu

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World Bank, 1818 H Street NW, Washington, DC 20433

Research Interests

Macroeconomics; development economics; labor markets and distributional impacts of policies; social protection and inequality in emerging markets; trade and development; quantitative macroeconomic modeling; public economics.

Professional Experience

Consultant, *World Bank*, Washington, DC

January 2024 – Present

- Analyzed labor market outcomes and economic transitions in developing countries using large-scale international survey datasets.
- Estimated long-run economic growth trajectories for developing economies using the World Bank's Long-Term Growth Model (LTGM); assessed how demographic and capital-accumulation dynamics shape medium-term growth and market convergence prospects.
- Examined economic growth and household-level inequality in China using Chinese household survey data.
- Studied middle-class formation and vulnerability in developing country contexts, with implications for domestic demand, market development, and inclusive growth.

Economist, *GM Financial*, Fort Worth, TX

October 2023 – December 2023

- Monitored and analyzed portfolio performance across multiple product lines using large-scale administrative data.
- Produced forecasts of portfolio performance and asset values; assessed downside risks to support data-driven decision-making.

Education

Ph.D., Economics University of Houston, Houston, TX *2017 – 2023*

M.A., Economics Binghamton University (SUNY), Binghamton, NY *2015 – 2017*

M.A., Environmental & Natural Resources Management Renmin University of China, Beijing *2013 – 2015*

B.S., Environmental Science; B.A., Agricultural Economics Renmin University of China, Beijing *2009 – 2013*

Research

Pension Reform, Child Investment, and Household Saving in China *Job Market Paper*

- Identified the causal effects of China's pension reform on household savings and child investment using a difference-in-differences design and cross-sectional/panel household survey data.

- Developed and numerically solved an overlapping generations (OLG) model to quantify policy effects on household behavior and fiscal sustainability through counterfactual analysis.

One-Child Policy, Pension Reform, and Household Saving Rates in China

- Developed and numerically solved an OLG model with endogenous fertility and human capital investment.
- Quantified the effects of demographic and social insurance policies on household savings and long-run economic outcomes via counterfactual simulations.

Research Experience

Research Assistant — Prof. Kei-Mu Yi, University of Houston *Summer 2018*

- Numerically solved a quantitative international trade model.

Research Assistant — Prof. Steven Craig, University of Houston *Summer 2021*

- Estimated population density via cubic splines using Census microdata; merged GIS and economic datasets; produced visualizations in ArcGIS and R.

Research Assistant — Prof. Bent Sorensen, University of Houston *Spring 2019*

- Collected and analyzed large consumer panel data (Nielsen); estimated household consumption patterns.

Teaching Experience

Instructor — Principles of Microeconomics, University of Houston *Spring 2020, Fall 2021*

Teaching Assistant — University of Houston *2017 – 2023*

- **International Trade**; Introduction to Econometrics; Intermediate Microeconomics
- Economics of Financial Crises; Macroeconomic Theory I (Ph.D.); Macro Modeling and Forecasting

Teaching Assistant — Binghamton University (SUNY) *2015 – 2017*

- **International Trade**; Educational Economics; Mathematics and Statistics (Ph.D.); Principles of Macroeconomics

Skills & Methods

Programming R, Python, Julia, Stata, MATLAB, SQL, SAS, GIS (ArcGIS)

Econometrics Causal inference, panel data and time-series analysis, quantitative macroeconomic modeling, machine learning

Languages English (fluent), Mandarin Chinese (native)

Seminars & Conferences

- Missouri Valley Economic Association Annual Meeting, 2020
- Macroeconomics Student Workshops, University of Houston, 2018 – 2022

Honors & Awards

- Graduate Fellowship, University of Houston, 2017 – 2023
- Graduate Fellowship, Binghamton University (SUNY), 2015 – 2017
- National Inspirational Scholarship (First Prize), Renmin University of China, 2010 – 2012
- Tsang-hinchi Scholarship, Renmin University of China, 2010 – 2012
- RUC Scholarship for International Summer Camp, Summer 2011

References

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